

Sony Bravia 9 Mini LED

Best mini LED TV to rival OLEDs?

₹4,17,900



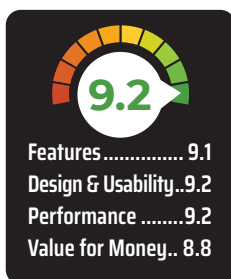
In the premium segment, I have always and unequivocally recommended OLED TVs above everything else. But this TV has certainly changed my mind. Yes, we have been testing the Bravia 9, Sony's current flagship TV and we have been testing it next to the Bravia 8 OLED TV.

The Bravia 9 does cost an arm and a leg but finally is a capable alternative to premium OLEDs, especially if you are looking for a 65-inch or larger size.

PICTURE QUALITY

We have the 75-inch variant ships with us which has a VA LCD panel along with Quantum dots technology. Viewing angles are not as big a problem as they were on the Bravia 7, but we did notice a slight shift at extreme angles but only when we were scrutinizingly looking for it.

The LED LCD panel is slightly reflective, but that also helps a sense of depth if you are watching in a relatively dark ambience - as is also recommended for HDR.



The colour temperature in both the Professional mode and cinema mode is close to standard D65. But first, make sure to disable the ambient light sensor, which makes the whites cooler or bluish in our normal viewing environment. Sony's Professional mode is similar to Filmmaker mode and is meant for purists. Another advantage is that popular apps including Netflix, Prime Videos and Bravia Core have their own calibrated modes.

The panel can reproduce almost 100% of Rec. 709 colour space used for SDR content. As for HDR, the Bravia 9 display supports almost 97% DCI-P3 coverage and 77% of BT2020 coverage in UV terms.

On a 10% Window, the Bravia 9 can be a staggering 3000 nits bright! In the professional mode with a white point close to standard D65, however, we recorded a maximum brightness of 1700 nits.

This high brightness translates to an impactful HDR experience. High APL scenes or bright scenes like scenes with snow or these bright sequences in Severance are rendered beautifully and feel better than on premium OLED TVs.

The TV supports HDR10 and Dolby Vision. The colour accuracy in HDR is impressive. We recorded a delta error of just 2.2 out of the box.

Contrary to what people believe, the dimming performance is not as much dependent on the number of zones but on the dimming algorithms. This again remains a Key Sony strength. Blooming in subtitles and other dimming artefacts are suppressed really well.

The Bravia 9 can render dark scenes very accurately but yes, it is still not a match for OLEDs.

Similarly, we also noticed that the Bravia 9 can not at times render the details on dark skin tones in bright scenes as faithfully. HDR scenes with both bright highlights and shadows are rendered masterfully.

Motion handling is excellent but not as fine as on OLED TVs.

In SDR, we recorded an average delta error of just 1.9 and a maximum delta error of 4.5 out of the box, which is indeed impressive. The professional mode restricts the brightness to 100 nits which is in line with mastering standards.

For watching in normal viewing environments, you can enable the high peak brightness setting or switch to Cinema mode.

Bravia 9 also does an excellent job of upscaling legacy content.

So, mini LED or OLED? We will sum up our findings at the end, so stay tuned for a bit more.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Powered by XRR Processor with 32GB storage, the Sony Bravia 9 is as snappy a TV as you'd expect at this price point. The content we played almost instantly switched to high-resolution settings and playback controls worked smoothly. We did not notice any unexpected jitters while switching between apps.

Casting and screen mirroring work seamlessly across Android and iOS devices since the TV supports Apple Airplay, Apple Homekit and Chromecast Built-in. The far-field microphones are